

Parks Commission – Recreation Report- February 11, 2026

Updates:

- **Weather Impacts:** Multiple closures and delays occurred due to inclement weather across facilities.
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Community Centers:

- **Community Centers:** Basketball season is underway at all centers. Schedules were adjusted due to weather; postponed games will be rescheduled.

Dunbar Community Center:

- **Warming & Overnight Shelter:** Served as a daytime warming center and overnight shelter during extreme cold. Multiple guests were served nightly with staff support from various departments.
 - **After-School Programs:** Homework assistance, activities, and basketball continue with steady attendance and revenue.
 - **Youth Basketball:** League play began; season concludes in February with tournaments for all divisions except Pre-K. Two-week suspension occurred due to weather.
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Southwest Community Center:

Youth Programs

- **Dance Classes:** Paused in January; resume in February. Marketing efforts are underway to increase participation.
- **Wednesday Art Night:** Weekly program continues; February Free Art Night features a Pan-African Suncatcher Workshop (Feb. 4).
- **Youth Engagement:** Participation remains low but stable; staff are introducing new ideas and collecting feedback via a suggestion box.

Youth Athletics

- **Basketball & Cheer:** Southwest Panthers competing in 6U–12U divisions. Cheer squad includes 12 participants. Communication with parents and coaches is strong.

Adult & Senior Programs

- **Southwest Steppers:** Strong participation continues; planning underway for “Dancing at Dusk” at River Market.
- **Low-Impact Senior Fitness:** Serves ~15 participants ages 65+.
- **Pickleball:** Equipment purchased; beginner pilot program planned for Thursday mornings.

Upcoming - Special Events

- African Dance Class – Feb. 14 (Free)
- Sneaker Ball Dance – Feb. 13 (\$5 registration)
- Loteria Game Night – Feb. 20 (Free)
- Black History Program (Live Wax Museum) – Feb. 28 (Free, registration required)

Facility Improvements (Planned)

- Ice machine installation
 - Gym wall padding and score table upgrades
 - Game room enhancements
 - Playground upgrade planning
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Stephens Community Center:

- **After-School Program:** 29 registered participants (58% capacity).
 - **Youth Sports:** Fall basketball (2 teams) and cheer (30 participants).
 - **Adult/Senior Activities:** Seniors attend programs four days per week.
 - **Staffing Needs:** 2 part-time custodians or 1 full-time custodian.
 - **Facility:** Reopened following renovations.
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West Central Community Center:

- **Youth Sports:** Basketball season active; all teams staffed and competing. Soccer advertising underway.
 - **Programs:** Karate program resumed with 15 participants.
 - **Community Outreach:** Winter coat drive extended through Jan. 22.
 - **Rentals:** 10 rentals in January.
 - **Maintenance:** Parking lot lighting needs repair.
 - **Staffing:** Evening receptionist and two activity assistants hired (start February). Recreation Programmer position reposted.
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East Little Rock Community Center:

- **Operations:** Facility impacted by city closures Jan. 26–30.
 - **Training:** Staff completing cybersecurity and safety training.
 - **Community Use:** Outdoor courts and park areas used 3–5 days/week for recreation and fitness.
 - **Maintenance:** Grounds upkeep ongoing; tennis courts in need of refurbishment.
 - **Meetings:** Neighborhood meeting held with 11 attendees; next meeting Feb. 9.
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Youth Athletics (All Centers):

- **Basketball:** 422 participants (5% increase from 2025)
 - **Soccer:** 47 registered; registration remains open
 - **Cheerleading:** 32 participants; season ongoing
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Adult Athletics:

- **Adult Basketball (30+ & 40+):** Resumes in 2026 at East Little Rock CC. Six teams per division. New score clock and equipment purchased.
 - **Adult Softball:** Spring league planning underway; ballfields closed until March 2026.
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Therapeutic Recreation:

- **Branch Out Program:** 21 participants enrolled; focus on fitness, socialization, and team building.
- **Marathon Participation:** Participants training for the Little Rock Marathon All-Abilities mile (Feb. 28).
- **Special Events:**
 - Parks Appreciation Taco Party – Feb. 5

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- Ballet Arkansas: *Cinderella* – Feb. 21 (18 enrolled)
 - 24th Annual TR Arts Festival – May 1 at State Fairgrounds
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Senior Programs – Active & Aging:

Senior Programs: activities include fitness, arts & crafts, bingo, games, Bible study, chair volleyball, pickleball, field trips, health screenings, outreach programs and social events.

- January closures due to weather January 26-February 2, 2026.
 - 2026 enrollment on-going at all sites.
 - Ongoing partnerships with Baptist Health.
 - Staff recognized for dedication and care.
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Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics:

- **Recognition:** Nominated by AY Magazine as a Best Fitness Gym.
 - **Memberships:** 2,700 total; 282 new in January
 - **Revenue:** \$596,594 (2025); \$28,669 (Jan. 2026)
 - **Attendance:** 150,010 total
 - **Programs:** 19 group fitness classes; strong participation.
 - **Aquatics:** 6 classes offered; new Aqua Fit class added on Wednesdays at 6 p.m.
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Rebsamen Tennis:

- Head pro Raul Bermudez named 2025 Arkansas Pro of the Year.
 - ATA has 60+ teams expected for spring.
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Rebsamen Golf & First Tee:

- **Golf Courses:** Cold weather slowed play; retail purchasing strategy adjusted.
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Outdoor Recreation:

- **Outdoor Recreation:** War Memorial Disc Golf course planning underway; public feedback event Feb. 21.
 - **Events:** “Squatch Till You Drop” trail run scheduled; registration opens Feb. 6.
 - **Programming:** First Day Hike held; lunchtime mountain bike rides ongoing.
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Museum of Arkansas Military History:

- **Attendance:** 1,074 total through January (on-site, off-site, and virtual).
- **Exhibits:** Thomas Hart Benton exhibit on display through July 31, 2026.
- **Programs:** Educational talks, tours, outreach, and partnerships ongoing.
- **Facility:** HVAC upgrades underway; completion expected early February.